

12-09-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09O8wdqpfaw
Publication Date	2025-12-10T11:08:35Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Report: Community Summary & Policy Analysis

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education was called to order by the presiding officer [00:03:59](#). Opening statements included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:16](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mrs. Barns Griffin, Dr. Washford, Mr. Irvick, and Mr. Lev.
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Heater (noted as traveling near the South Pole/Drake Passage) [00:04:04](#).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. Reynolds and the Board President managed proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board held a moment of silence and recited the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:16](#). Special recognition was given to Jose, a student artist from Southview Elementary School whose artwork was selected for the district's annual holiday cards sent out to community partners [00:08:18](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and routine consent agenda items were approved (with the specific removal of a custodial position at Southview Elementary from Personnel Recommendations Part B) 00:36:10. Approved by Voice Vote 00:37:13.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:04:20 Superintendent's Report & School Presentation: Northview Elementary

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds (Superintendent) and Mrs. Allen (Principal of Northview Elementary), alongside staff members Leah Britain (Master Teacher) and Jamie Jones (PTO Leadership).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Superintendent Reynolds highlighted educator awards, music program growth (over 300 elementary students participating in voluntary honor choirs), and art displays representing every school.
 - Northview Elementary Principal Mrs. Allen presented updates on school enrollment (367 students, PreK-5), literacy initiatives aligned with the science of reading, professional development utilizing reading modules for instructional aides, and student academic/attendance goals (averaging 94.9% attendance).
 - The board discussed Ball State University partnerships, including the work-study tutoring program, student residency programs, and second/third-grade reading interventions.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board action required.

00:37:31 November 2025 Financial Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Don (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Officer).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Mr. Don reported on the 11-month calendar year financial snapshot under cash-basis accounting. The state basic grant estimate rose to approximately \$47.7 million (\$150,000 increase due to favorable enrollment modeling).
 - Total cash balance reached \$42.6 million, significantly impacted by the recent receipt of \$9.9 million in bond proceeds designated for facility upgrades.
 - The state loan balance decreased to \$5.9 million (down from \$12 million in 2019).
 - Payroll expenditures reflect the successful integration of former SSC maintenance, facilities, and custodial employees, yielding a net operational savings of approximately \$1.2 million annually despite higher headcounts.
 - Board members questioned capital project timelines, specifically noting that Muny Fieldhouse HVAC updates, roofing projects, and Southside Middle School

track/tennis court resurfacing will commence in Summer 2026. Board members also encouraged exploring alternative community uses for the tennis court space.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:48:35](#).

[00:48:42](#) Annual Insurance Premium Renewals (Property, Casualty, Workers' Comp, and Cyber)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Don, with agency support from USI Insurance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Presented annual property, casualty, workers' compensation, and cyber insurance package renewals effective January 1st.
 - Total premiums increased by just over 7% to \$978,000 (up from \$913,000 the previous year, and notably higher than historical figures around \$330,000 three years prior).
 - Mr. Don and board members discussed external macroeconomic factors driving the increases, including national weather disasters, property replacement value inflation, and expanded payroll totals from bringing custodial/maintenance staff in-house.
 - The board noted that these mandatory operational fund expenditures place continuous pressure on the district budget.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:03:10](#).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **[00:56:42](#) Student Delegation / Class Credit Participants:** A group of Muncie Central High School seniors attending the meeting for class credit addressed the board during board dialogue and introductions:
 - **Haley Rollins:** Senior planning to pursue nursing (considering UNC or Johns Hopkins) [00:57:06](#).
 - **Anthony English Davis:** Senior interested in cybersecurity or digital design [00:57:37](#).
 - **Chloe Miller:** Senior pursuing respiratory therapy, considering Ball State University [00:57:50](#).
 - **Ariana Kerr:** Senior planning to attend Ball State University for business [00:58:08](#).
 - **Morgan Kerr:** Senior planning to study pre-dental at Ball State University [00:58:24](#).
 - **Nia Prior:** Senior aspiring to become an elementary art teacher and attend Ball State University [00:58:33](#).
 - **Jayla:** Senior planning to attend Purdue University [00:58:54](#).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Upcoming purchasing wave for student Chromebooks scheduled for February.
 - Discussion regarding upcoming Martin Luther King Jr. citizenship awards and district events.
 - The Board President cautioned that despite high current cash balances driven by bond proceeds, financial headwinds ("30-foot waves") loom ahead for district operations.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [01:03:08](#).
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